

PHISHING EMAIL ANALYSIS & AWARENESS REPORT.

Prepared by
Mukesh Chegondi
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Introduction

Phishing is a cyber attack technique in which attackers impersonate trusted organizations or individuals to deceive users into revealing sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, banking credentials, OTPs, and personal information.

These attacks are usually performed through fraudulent emails, fake login pages, malicious links, or deceptive messages that create fear, urgency, or excitement.

Phishing attacks remain one of the most common cyber threats affecting individuals, businesses, and organizations worldwide.

This report analyzes phishing email samples and identifies suspicious indicators, attack techniques, associated risks, and preventive measures.

OBJECTIVES

Objectives of the assessment

- The primary objectives of this phishing email analysis are:
- To identify phishing characteristics in suspicious emails
- To analyze malicious sender behavior
- To examine social engineering techniques used by attackers
- To classify phishing risks based on severity
- To recommend preventive security measures
- To improve cyber security awareness among users

SCOPE OF ASSESSMENT

Scope

This assessment focuses on safe and passive analysis of phishing email samples.

Included in Scope

- Sender email analysis
- Suspicious link inspection
- Email content analysis
- Social engineering identification
- Risk classification
- Security awareness recommendations

Excluded from Scope

- Malware execution
- Clicking malicious links
- Credential submission
- Active exploitation
- Unauthorized access attempts

The analysis was conducted ethically and without interacting with harmful links or systems.

ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

Methodology

The phishing email samples were analyzed using safe manual inspection techniques.

Assessment Process

- Collection of phishing email samples
- Verification of sender identity
- Inspection of suspicious URLs
- Identification of social engineering tactics
- Risk assessment and classification
- Documentation of findings
- Recommendation of preventive controls

Tools Used

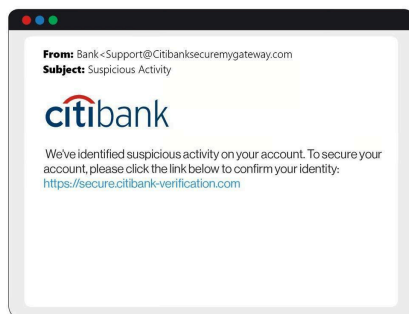
Web Browser

Screenshot Documentation

Manual Email Analysis

PHISHING SAMPLE 1 ANALYSIS

Sample 1 – Citibank Suspicious Activity Scam



● HIGH RISK

Observation

- The email impersonates Citibank and attempts to create panic by claiming suspicious activity on the user's bank account.
- The message pressures users to click a verification link to secure their account.

Identified Indicators

- Fake sender email address
- Suspicious verification URL
- Urgent security-related message
- Request for immediate action
- Brand impersonation

Attack Type

- Credential Theft Phishing
- Potential Impact
- Banking credential theft
- Unauthorized account access
- Financial fraud

Attack Type

- Credential Theft Phishing

Potential Impact

- Banking credential theft
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- Identity compromise

DETAILED TECHNICAL ANALYSIS SAMPLE 1

Detailed Findings – Citibank Scam

1. Fake Sender Address

The sender email address does not belong to the official Citibank domain and appears suspicious.

2. Malicious Verification Link

The embedded URL contains misleading domain naming intended to imitate a legitimate banking website.

3. Urgency Tactic

The attacker attempts to create fear and panic to force immediate user action.

4. Brand Impersonation

The email uses Citibank branding to increase trust and deceive victims.

Security Indicators

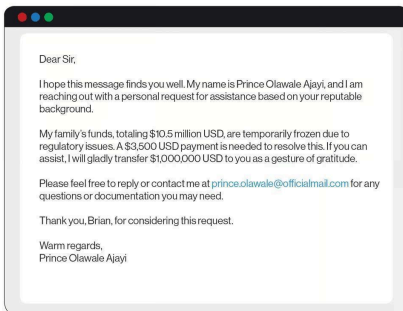
Indicator	Status
Fake Domain	 Detected
Suspicious Link	 Detected
Urgency Tactic	 Detected
Brand Impersonation	 Detected

Recommended Mitigation

-
- Verify sender domains carefully
 - Avoid clicking unknown links
 - Access banking websites manually
 - Enable Multi-Factor Authentication
 - Report suspicious emails immediately

DETAILED TECHNICAL SAMPLE ANALYSIS 2

Nigerian Prince Scam



● MEDIUM-HIGH RISK

Observation

The email claims that the sender requires financial assistance to release frozen funds and promises a large monetary reward in return.

This is a classic advance-fee fraud scam designed to manipulate victims emotionally.

Identified Indicators

- Unrealistic financial promise
- Unknown sender identity
- Emotional manipulation
- Request for money transfer
- Suspicious communication pattern

Attack Type

- Advance Fee Fraud Scam

Potential Impact

-
- Financial loss
 - Identity theft
 - Fraudulent transactions
 - Social engineering exploitation

Detailed Technical Analysis – Sample 2

Detailed Findings – Advance Fee Fraud

1. Financial Manipulation

The attacker promises a large financial reward to gain trust and encourage victim participation.

2. Emotional Exploitation

The email attempts to create sympathy and urgency.

3. Suspicious Sender

The sender is unknown and uses a non-verifiable communication address.

4. Advance Payment Request

Victims are requested to provide money before receiving the promised reward.

Security Indicators

Indicator	Severity
Financial Manipulation	 Medium
Unknown Sender	 Medium
Fraudulent Promise	 High
Emotional Exploitation	 Medium

 Medium

Recommended Mitigation

- Ignore suspicious financial offers
- Verify sender authenticity
- Never transfer money to unknown individuals
- Report scam emails to email providers

Social Engineering Techniques

Social Engineering Techniques Identified

- Phishing attacks often exploit human psychology rather than technical vulnerabilities.
- Common Techniques Observed
- Fear and panic creation
- Urgency and pressure tactics
- Trust impersonation
- Emotional manipulation
- Financial temptation

Examples

- “Your account has suspicious activity”
- “Immediate verification required”
- “You will receive a large reward”
- “Urgent response needed”

Impact of Social Engineering

- These techniques manipulate users into performing actions that compromise security and personal information.

Preventive Measures

Recommended Security Practices

For Users

- Verify sender email addresses carefully
- Avoid clicking suspicious links
- Never share passwords or OTPs
- Use Multi-Factor Authentication
- Keep systems and browsers updated
- Report suspicious emails immediately

For Organizations

- Conduct phishing awareness training
- Implement email filtering solutions
- Deploy anti-spam protection
- Monitor suspicious email activity
- **Encourage cyber security awareness**

Conclusion :

Phishing attacks continue to be one of the most dangerous and widespread cyber threats targeting individuals and organizations.

This assessment demonstrated how attackers use fake emails, deceptive links, financial manipulation, and social engineering tactics to exploit victims.

Proper cyber security awareness, cautious email handling, and implementation of preventive security measures are essential to minimize phishing-related risks.

Continuous education and awareness play a critical role in defending against phishing attacks.

REFERENCES

Keepnet Phishing Awareness Examples

OWASP Security Awareness Guidelines

Cyber Security Awareness Resources

Public Phishing Education Materials

Email Security Best Practices